PPP-S-1853
December 10, 1974

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SKIDS, WOOD WITH CAPS

This specification was approved by the Commissioner,
Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration,
for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers skids and caps made of wood (for intended use see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The skids shall be one of the following types, classes, styles, size and grades, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Skid.
  Class 1 - Two-way entry for paper.
    Style A - See 3.2.1.1.
    Style B - See 3.2.1.2.
  Class 2 - Four-way entry for paper.
  Class 3 - Two-way entry (see 3.2.1.3 and figs. 1 or 2).
    Style C - See 3.2.1.3.1 and fig. 1.
      Size - See table I.
    Style D - See 3.2.1.3.2 and fig. 2.
      Size - See table I.
    Style E - See 3.2.1.3.3 and fig 2.
      Sise - See table I.

Type II - Caps.
  Class 1 - Flat construction.
    Style A . See 3.2.2.1.1.
    Style B - See 3.2.2.1.2 and fig. 3.
  Class 2 - Frame construction see 3.2.2.2 and fig. 4.

Skids and caps shall be of the following grades:
  Grade I - Hardwood (see 3.1.1.1).
  Grade II - Softwood (see 3.1.1.2).
  Grade III - Either hard or soft woods at the option of the manufacturer.

TABLE I.

Skids		Caps	
Class 3		Class 1, Style B and Class 2	
Size	Length-A x width-B in inches	Size	Length-A x width-B in inches
1	21 x 25	1	48 x 48
2	29 x 35	2	48 x 49-1/4
3	31 x 40		
4	40 x 48		

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-04-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

MM-L-736 - Lumbar and Timber: Hardwood
MM-L-751 - Lumber; Softwood
QQ-S-781 - Strapping, Steel and Seals
FF-N-105 - Nails; Brads, Staples and Spikes: Wire, Cut and Wrought

Federal Standard

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification end other Federal. Specifications required by activities "outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General- Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks end the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage,
MIL-STD-1363 - Measurement of Wood Moisture Content.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form apart of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation forbids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Frieght Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Research and Engineering Council of the Graphic Arts Industry, Inc.:

Standard for Paper Skids - 1963

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Research and Engineering Council of the Graphic Arts Industry, 1515 Wilson Blvd., Arlington, VA 22209.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Lumber. Lumber shall be either hardwood or softwood as specified (see 1.2 and 6.2). The moisture content, unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), shall be that specified in table II.

TABLE II. Moisture content

Deckboards for skids and caps	Average of 19 percent with no single piece over 22 percent.
Stringer boards for caps	Average of 19 percent with no single piece over 22 percent.
Stringers or runners for skids	Not over 26 percent.

3.1.1.1 Hardwood shall meet the requirements of MM-L-736. The grade shall be No. 3 common of the Hardwood Lumber Grading Rule.

3.1.1.2 Softwood shall meet the requirements of MM-L-751. The grade shall be one Of those in table III.

TABLE III

Rules	Grade
CL[1/]	2 Common (sterling - WWPINE) or better.
NELMA[2/]	No. 2 common or better.
NHPMA[3/]	2 Common or better.
SPIB[4/]	Standard or better.
WCLB[5/]	Construction or better.
WWPA[6/]	2 Common (sterling - 1WP) or better.

1/ Standard Grading Rules for Canadian Lumber.

2/ Standard Grading Rules for Northeastern Lumber.

3/ Official Grading Rules for Eastern White Pine, Norway Pine, Jack Pine, Eastern Spruce, Balsam Fir, Eastern Hemlock, and Tamarack.

4/ Standsrd Grading Rules for Southern Pine Lumber.

5/ Standard Grading Rule. for West Coast Lumber.

6/ Grading Rules for Western Lumber.

3.1.2 Fastening.

3.1.2.1 Type I, classes 1 and 2, and type II, class 1, style A skids. Nails for these types and classes shall meet the requirements of the Research Engineering Council Paper Skid Standard dated 1963 (RECS). The hardness of nails shall be minimum Rockwell C42.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.2.2 Type I, class 3, styles C, D and E skids and Type II, class 2 caps. Nails for these types and class shall be FF-N-105, type II, styles 4, 7 and 9, size 8d, cement coated.

3.1.2.3 Type II, class 1, style B caps. Nails for this type shall be FF-N-105, type II, styles 4, 7 and 9, size 3D, cement coated.

3.2 Desire and construction.

3.2.1 Type I, skids.

3.2.1.1 Class 1, two-way entry for paper.

3.2.1.1.1 Style A. Class 1, style A skids shall be constructed in accordance with the figure and description for style A in the RECS Paper Skid Standard, dated 1963.

3.2.1,1.2 Style B. Class 1, style B skids shall be constructed in accordance with the figure and description for style B in the RECS Paper Skid Standard, dated 1963.

3.2.1.2 Class 2, four-way entry for paper. Class 2 skids shall be constructed in accordance with the figure and description for four-way entry paper skids in the RECS Paper Skid Standard, dated 1963.

3.2.1.3 Class 3, two-way entry general purpose. Dimensions shall be as specified (see 6.2) and shall be one of those in table I.

3,2.1.3,1 Style C. Class 3, style C skids shall be constructed in accordance with figure 1 and of materials specified in 3.1.

3.2.1.3.2 Style D. Class 3, style D skids shall be constructed in accordance with figure 2 and of materials specified in 3.1.

3.2.1.3.3 Style E. Class 3, style E skids shall be constructed in accordance with figure 2 and of materials specified in 3.1.

3.2.2 Type 11. caps.

3.2.2.1 Class 1. flat construction.

3.2.2.1.1 Style A. Class 1, style A caps shall be constructed in accordance with the figure and description for cover or cap in the RECS Paper Skid Standard, dated 1963.

3.2.2.1.2 Style B,. Clam 1, style B caps shall be constructed in accordance with figure 3 and of materials specified in 3.1.

3.2.2,2 Class 2, frame construction. Class 2 caps shall be constructed in accordance with figure 4 and of materials specified in 3.1.

3.3 Assembly. Skids and caps shall be assembled with stringers parallel and square (90°) edges within $\pm$ 5°.

3.4 Workmanship. All surfaces shall be free of slivers caused by damaged wood fibers that could cause injury to handling personnel. Nails heads or points shall net protrude from decks, stringers, or stringer boards, or from the boards of the caps.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for-inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Component and material inspection. The supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with reference specifications and standards, and the requirements specified herein.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Classification of inspection. Inspection shall be classified as follows:

(a) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).
(b) Inspection of preparation for delivery (see 4.6).

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Sampling. Sampling for examination and testing shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection levels and the Acceptable Quality Level's (AQL) as specified herein.

4.4.2 Lot. For skids and caps, a lot shall be all those of the same type; style, end group offered for delivery at one time. For nails, the lot shall be all those on hand which are intended to be used in fabrication of the skids or caps.

4.4.3 Inspection of nails. Prior to starting production, the supplier shall provide assurance that nails proposed for use in skid and cap fabrication comply with requirements specified herein. In the absence of certification from the nail supplier, the pallet supplier shall perform or have performed the inspection necessary to assure conformance. If the nails are acceptable, no further inspection need be performed if the supplier continues to use the same type by the same manufacturer as originally accepted.

4.4.3.1 Examination. Sample nails selected in accordance with 4.4.1 shall be examined for defects specified in 4.5.2.2. A double sampling plan shall be used with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective and and inspection level of S-4. Samples shall be chosen randomly, some from each box of nails on hand.

4.4.3.2 Tests. Nails selected in accordance with 4.4.1 shall be tested as specified in 4.5.1. A double sampling plan shall be used with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective and an inspection level of S-4. The samples chosen for 4.4.3.1 maybe used for 4.4.3.2.

4.4.4 Skids and caps. For examination and test purposes, a sample unit shall be a completely assembled skid or cap.

4.4.4.1 Examination. Nails, skids and caps selected in accordance with 4.4.1 shall be examined for defects listed in table IV. The AQL for major defects shall be 4.0 and for total defects shall be 6.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4,4.4.2 Tests. Sample skids and caps selected in accordance with 4.4,1 shall be tested in accordance with 4.5.2.1. The AQL for the moisture content test shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units with an inspection level of S-4.

4.5 Inspection procedure.

4.5.1 Examination. Nails and completed skids or caps shall be examined as specified in previous paragraphs for the defects classified in table IV.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Nails	101. Improper length.	X	
	102. Incorrect diameter.	X	
	103. Incorrect thread angle or number of flutes.	X	
	104. Improper point.	X	
	105. Improper head diameter.	X	
Wood components	106. Wood used of less dense group than specified.	X	
	107. Wood components not of moisture content specified.	X	
	108. Wood components not in accordance with RECGAI Standard for Paper Skids - 1963.	X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects (con.)

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Assembled skids and caps	109. Skids and caps of improper type, style, or size.	X	
	110. Skids and caps not square within specified tolerances.	X	
	111. Strap notches not located as specified.		X
	112. Deckboards of width less than minimum specified.	X	
	113. Deckboards and stringers not surfaced or smooth sawn as specified.		X
	114. Stringers and deckboards secured together with less than the number of nails specified.	X	
	115. Nails not completely driven or points protruding.	X	

4.5.2 Tests.

4.5.2.1 Moisture content. Moisture content shall be determined using the electric-moisture meter method of MIL-STD-1363. A minimum of five readings shall be taken at random locations on each sample skid or cap. The average value of the five-readings shall meet the requirements of table I.

4.5.2.2 Nail hardness. Tests for hardness of nails shall be performed in accordance with the applicable portions of ASTM E18. Hardness shall meet the requirements of 3.1.2.

4.6 Inspection of preparation for delivery.

4.6.1 Quality conformance inspection.

4.6.1.1 Unit of product. For inspection purposes, a complete pack of either skids or skids and caps shall be considered the unit of product.

4.6.1.2 Sending. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 from a lot offered for delivery at one time.

4.6.1.3 Examination. Samples selected in accordance with 4.6.1.2 shall be examined using an AQL of 2.5 percent defective for the defects shown in table V.

TABLE V. Defects

Examine	Defect
Skids and caps	116. Quantity in a bundle not as specified. 117. Bundling and strapping not as specified.
Marking	118. Incorrect, missing, or illegible.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. None

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level B. When specified (see 6.2), skids and caps shall be packed in bundles secured with a single strap conforming to QQ-S-781, type I or IV, finish A or C as specified (see 6.2), 3/4 inch by 0.031 or 0.035 inch. The strap shall pass through the bundle as shown in figure 5. A bundle height shall not exceed 58 inches. This height shall include caps between the decks of the skids when caps are required.

5.2.2 Level C. Skids and caps shall be packed in a manner to assure lowest freight rate and compliance with Uniform Freight Classification rules or National Motor Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking for shipment shall be in accordance with the shipping container requirements of Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

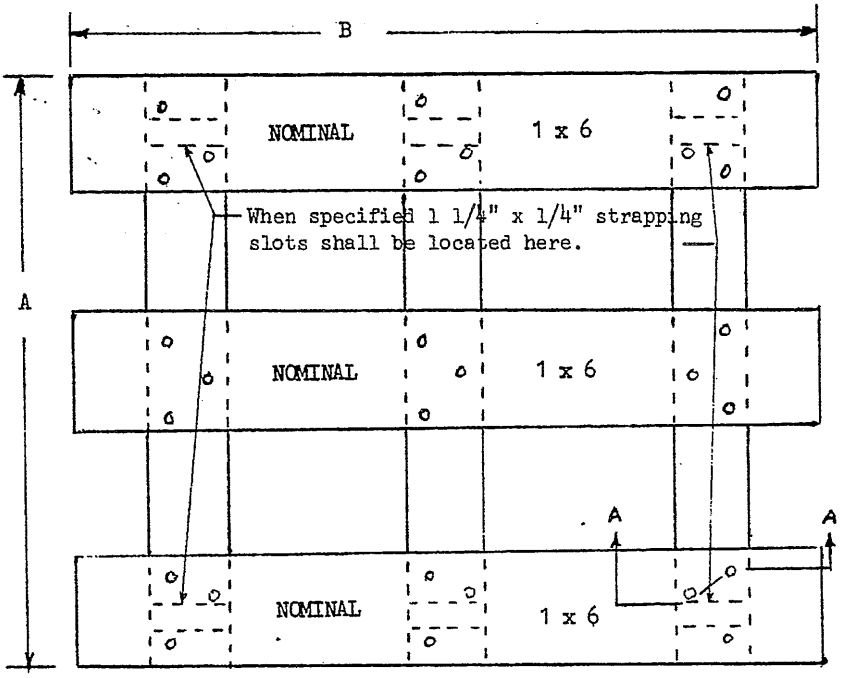
6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Skids and caps covered by this specification are intended for use in shipping and handling sheet paper by forklift and handlelift trucks and for general materials handling operation in storage and distribution system.

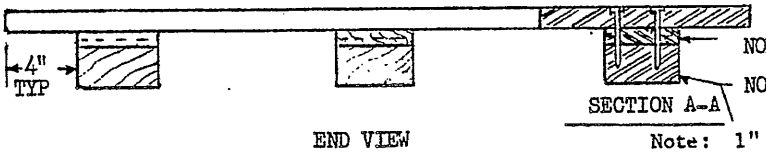
6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in the procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, style, and group of skid or cap (see 1.2).
(c) Size of type 1, class 3 skids or type II, class 1, style B and class 2 caps.
(d) Moisture content when other than that specified (see 3.1.1).
(e) Select applicable level of packing required (see 5.2).
(f) Strapping finish required for bundling skids and caps (see 5.2.1).
(g) When strapping slots are required.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



PLAN VIEW



END VIEW

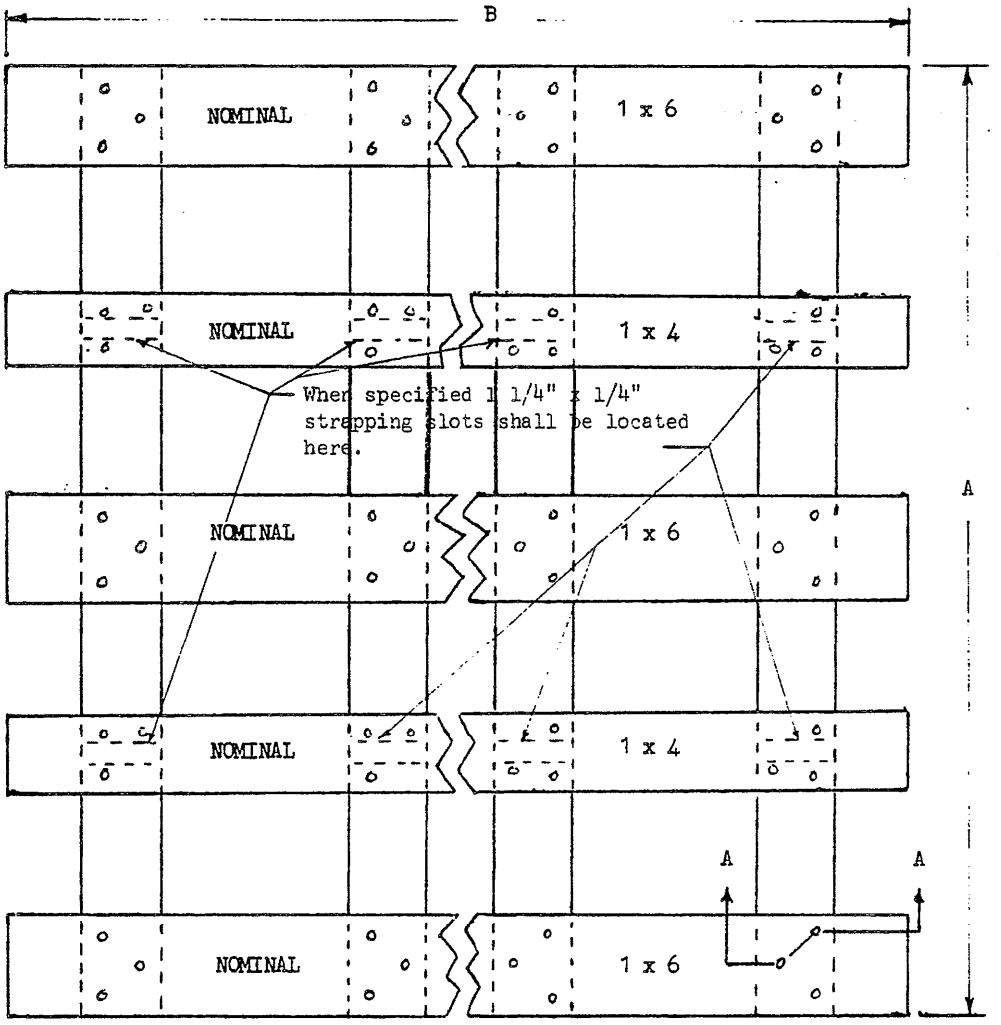
SECTION A-A

Lumber may be smooth sawn on all sides to nominal thickness shown.

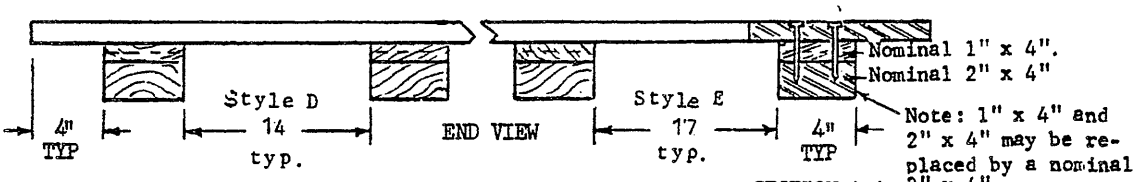
Note: 1" x 4" and 2" x 4" may be replaced by a nominal 3" x 4".

FIGURE 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



PLAN VIEW

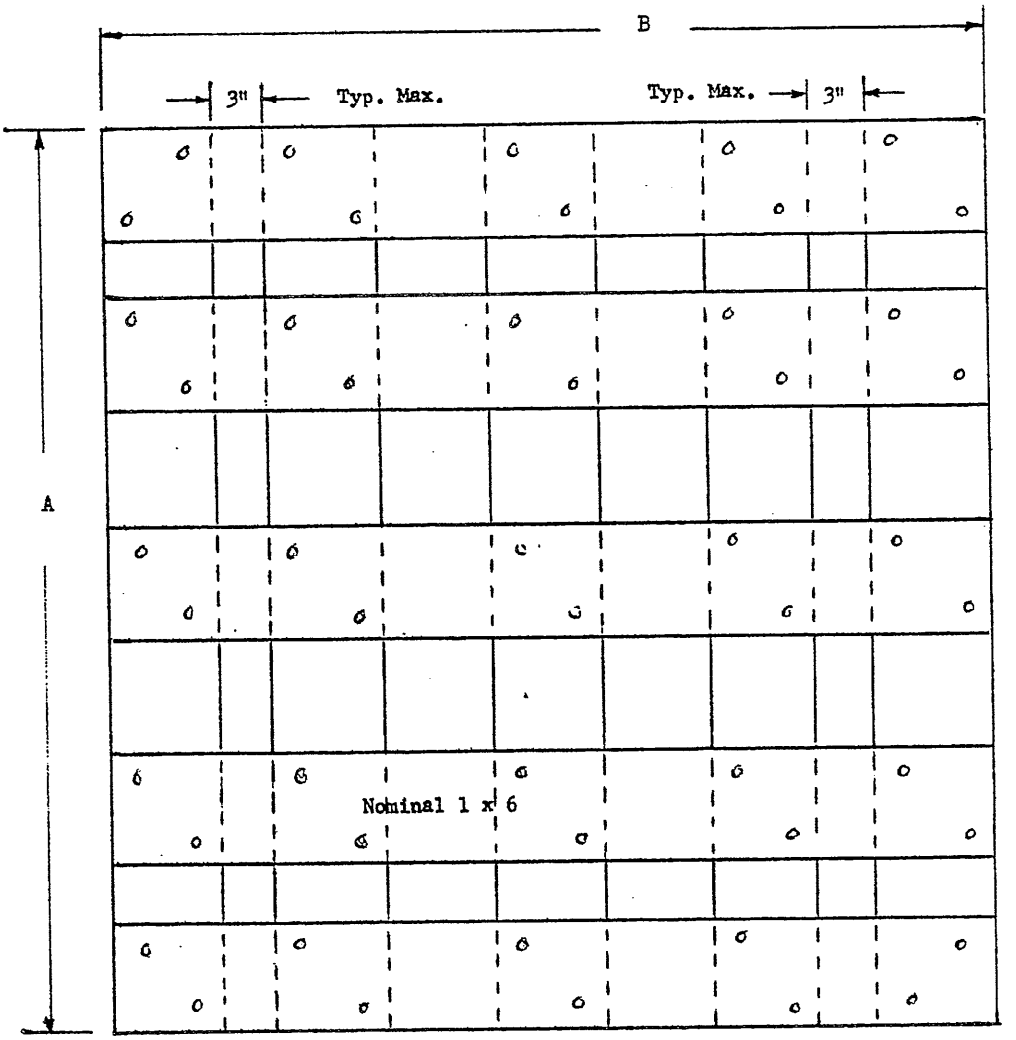


SECTION A-A

Lumber maybe smooth sawn on all sides to nominal thickness shown.

FIGURE 2

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



PLAN VIEW

END VIEW

Lumber maybe smooth sawn on all sides to nominal thickness shown

FIGURE 3

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

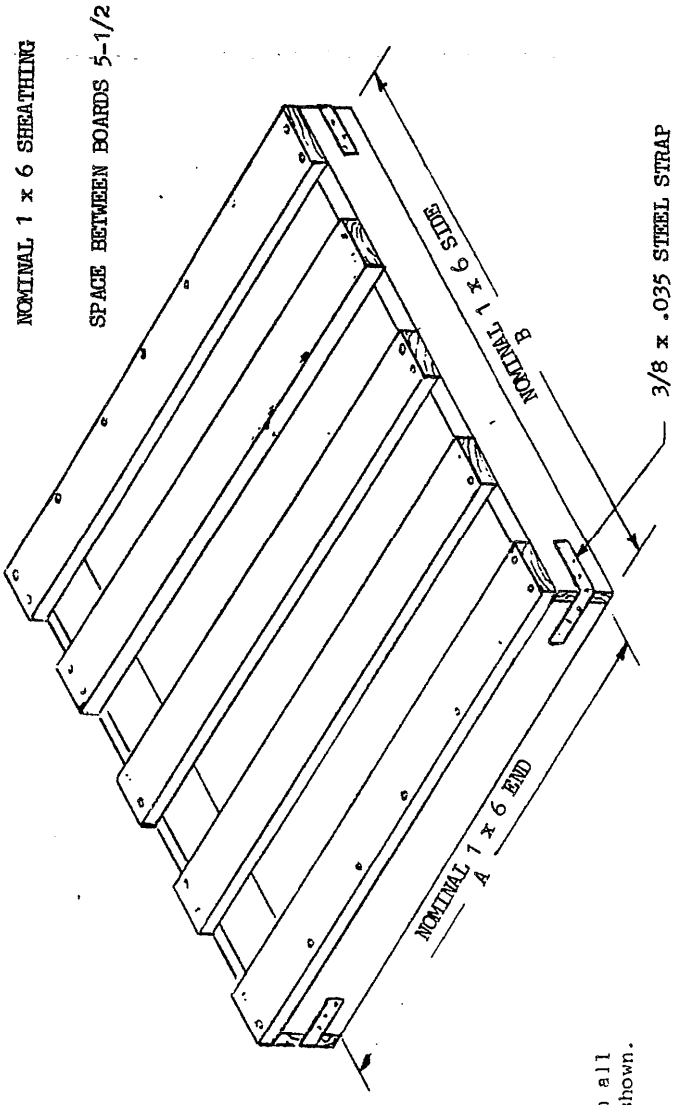
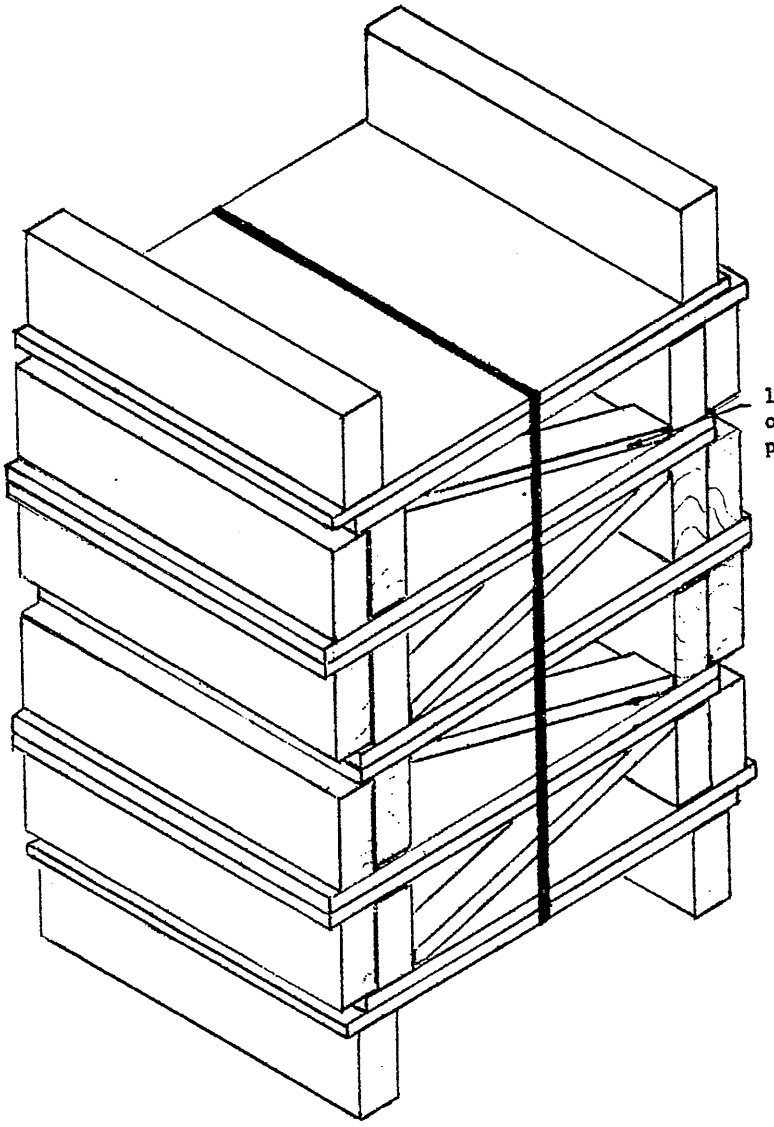


FIGURE 4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



Type I, Class 1, Style A and Class 2

FIGURE 5

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Preparing activity:

GSA - FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 35 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:52Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.